

Word family: **well / better / best / wellness / well-being / well-known / well-off**

Base word: well

Comparative/superlative when it corresponds to “good/well”: better, best

Related forms/extensions: wellness, well-being, well-known, well-off

Part of speech: adverb (副詞) / adjective (形容詞) / noun (名詞) / verb (動詞) / discourse marker/interjection (語篇標記／感嘆用法)

Your sentence:

> “Another reason it **worked so well** was that it sold more than a product; it sold a feeling.”

A full family sweep shows that **well is extremely polyfunctional**. It is much richer than it first appears.

Its major modern uses include:

1. doing something successfully or to a high standard;
2. being healthy;
3. completely/thoroughly;
4. by a considerable amount;
5. appropriately/suitably;
6. discourse marker **Well, ...**;
7. noun **well** = a deep hole/source for water, oil, etc.;
8. verb **well** = liquid/emotion rising or gathering;
9. several extremely common fixed expressions such as **as well, may as well, well worth**.

Meaning in your passage

Here:

> **worked so well**

means:

was very effective / achieved its intended effect very successfully.

The advertisement successfully persuaded the speaker and created the emotional effect it was designed to create.

繁體中文: **效果非常好; 非常有效地達到了原本想達到的目的**

Natural translation:

> “Another reason it worked so well...”

「這則廣告之所以**效果這麼好／這麼有效**，另一個原因是.....」

So here:

****well = 以成功、有效而令人滿意的方式****

1. ****well = successfully / effectively (行動／方法／系統) — 好地; 有效地; 成功地****

This is your original meaning.

Practice 1 — Original

> “The advertisement ****worked very well****.”

「這則廣告****效果非常好／非常有效****。」

Practice 2

> “The new system works ****well****.”

「新系統****運作得很好****。」

Practice 3

> “The treatment worked surprisingly ****well****.”

「這項治療的****效果出奇地好****。」

****well = 某項行動、方法或系統能成功達到預期目的, 效果令人滿意****

2. ****well = skillfully / to a high standard (技能／表現) — 做得好; 高水準地****

Practice 4

> “She speaks English very ****well****.”

「她英語說得****很好／很流利****。」

Practice 5

> “He played the piano **well**.”

「他鋼琴彈得**很好／水準很高**。」

well = 某項技能、工作或表現達到良好／高水準

This is the classic adverb corresponding to **good**.

3. **well** = in a satisfactory way (事情進展) — 順利地; 良好地

Practice 6

> “The meeting went **well**.”

「會議進行得**很順利**。」

Practice 7

> “Everything went **well** during the trip.”

「旅行期間一切都**很順利**。」

well = 某件事情的進展、結果或過程令人滿意, 沒有重大問題

4. **well** = in a thorough/complete way (了解／記住／準備) — 充分地; 徹底地; 非常清楚地

This is an important extension.

Practice 8

> “I know the area **well**.”

「我對這個地區**非常熟悉／很了解**。」

Practice 9

> “Make sure the material is **well** mixed.”

「確保材料已經**充分混合均勻**。」

well = 某件事進行得充分、徹底或深入

Common:

* know well = 很了解

* remember well = 記得很清楚

* well prepared = 準備充分

* well organized = 組織完善

5. **well + adjective/past participle (程度強化) — 很; 非常; 充分地**

Well can strengthen certain adjectives or participles.

Practice 10

> “She is **well aware** of the risks.”

「她**非常清楚**當中的風險。」

Practice 11

> “The issue is **well understood**.”

「這個問題已經被**充分理解**。」

well + adjective/participle = 表示程度很高、充分或非常

Common:

* well aware = 非常清楚

* well prepared = 準備充分

* well informed = 資訊充分

* well established = 已充分建立／公認

* well deserved = 實至名歸

6. **well + before/after/over/under (數量／時間程度) — 遠遠; 大大; 明顯超過**

A very useful degree meaning.

Practice 12

> “We arrived ****well before**** the meeting started.”

「我們在會議開始前****早了很多****便到達。」

Practice 13

> “The price is ****well over**** \$100.”

「價格****遠超過**** 100 美元。」

****well = 表示時間、數量或程度與某個界線相差甚遠****

Common:

* well before = 早很多

* well after = 晚很多

* well over = 遠超過

* well below = 遠低於

7. ****well worth + noun/-ing(價值) — 非常值得****

A very common construction.

Practice 14

> “The headphones are ****well worth**** the price.”

「這副耳機****非常值得這個價錢／很物有所值****。」

Practice 15

> “The museum is ****well worth visiting****.”

「這間博物館****非常值得參觀****。」

****well worth = 價值或好處很高, 因此非常值得投入金錢、時間或努力****

Note:

> **well worth doing** 

> not *well worth to do* 

8. **well = healthy (人／身體) — 健康的; 身體狀況良好的**

Here, **well** is an adjective.

Practice 16

> “You don’t look **well**.”

「你看起來**身體不太舒服／不太健康**。」

Practice 17

> “She wasn’t **well** enough to go to work.”

「她身體**不舒服到無法上班**。」

well — adjective = 身體健康、沒有生病或明顯不適的

This is genuinely different from adverbial **well = 做得好**.

9. **well = satisfactory / all right (情況) — 良好; 沒問題**

Especially in slightly formal or literary expressions.

Practice 18

> “All is **well**.”

「一切都**安好／沒有問題**。」

Practice 19

> “Everything appears to be **well**.”

「一切看來都**沒有問題／狀況良好**。」

well = 某個情況處於令人安心、正常或良好的狀態

This use is less common than ****fine/okay**** in everyday conversation.

10. ****Well, ... (語篇標記) — 嗯;那麼;這個嘛****

This is one of the most important non-lexical uses.

****Well**** can introduce:

- * hesitation;
- * an answer;
- * disagreement;
- * a change of topic;
- * a conclusion;
- * a reaction.

Practice 20

> “****Well****, I’m not completely sure.”

「****嗯／這個嘛****，我也不是完全確定。」

Practice 21

> “****Well****, what should we do next?”

「****那麼****，我們接下來應該做甚麼？」

****Well, ... = 用來整理思緒、緩和語氣、引出回答或轉換話題的語篇標記****

It often has no single literal Chinese translation.

11. ****Well? (催促回答／詢問結果) — 怎樣? ;然後呢? ;如何? ****

A standalone conversational use.

Practice 22

> “****Well? **** What did she say?”

「**怎樣？** 她說了甚麼？」

Practice 23

> “**Well?** Did you pass?”

「**怎麼樣？** 你及格了嗎？」

Well? = 催促對方繼續說、回答或告知結果

Tone matters greatly.

12. **as well = also / too — 也; 同樣**

A very common fixed expression.

Practice 24

> “I bought the headphones and a new charger **as well**.”

「我買了耳機, **也**買了一個新充電器。」

Practice 25

> “She speaks French and Spanish **as well**.”

「她會說法語, **也**會說西班牙語。」

as well = 另外也包括某人／某事, 意思接近 also / too

Usually appears near the end.

13. **as well as + noun/-ing (附加資訊) — 以及; 除了……之外也……**

Practice 26

> “The headphones are comfortable **as well as** practical.”

「這副耳機既實用, **也很舒適**。」

Practice 27

> “She enjoys travelling **as well as** learning languages.”

「她除了喜歡旅行，**也**喜歡學習語言。」

A as well as B = 除了 B 之外，A 亦成立／包括 A 和 B

Be careful: it does not always behave grammatically exactly like **and**.

14. **may/might as well + verb** — 不如……; 反正可以……; 最好還是……

A very useful idiomatic construction.

Practice 28

> “We’re already here, so we **might as well stay**.”

「既然已經來到，**不如**留下來吧。」

Practice 29

> “If the repair costs that much, we **may as well buy** a new one.”

「如果維修要花這麼多錢，**倒不如**買新的。」

may/might as well = 在現有情況下，某個行動是合理、方便或沒有更好選擇的做法

15. **well and truly** = completely / definitely — 完完全全地; 徹底地

A common British expression.

Practice 30

> “We were **well and truly** lost.”

「我們真的**徹底**迷路了。」

Practice 31

> “The old system is **well and truly** outdated.”

「舊系統已經**完全過時**。」

well and truly = 用來強烈表示某狀態完全、確實成立

16. **well** = deep hole for water (取水) — 井; 水井

Now **well** is a noun and the meaning is completely different.

Practice 32

> “The village gets water from a **well**.”

「村莊從一口**水井**取水。」

Practice 33

> “They dug a **well** behind the house.”

「他們在屋後挖了一口**井**。」

well — noun = 人工挖／鑽入地下以取得地下水的深洞

17. **well** = hole/source for oil/gas (石油／天然氣) — 油井; 氣井

A technical extension of the noun.

Practice 34

> “The company drilled a new oil **well**.”

「公司鑽了一口新的**油井**。」

Practice 35

> “The gas **well** began production last year.”

「那口**天然氣井**去年開始生產。」

****well** = 為抽取地下石油、天然氣等資源而鑽出的井

18. ****well** = enclosed/recessed vertical space (建築／結構) — 井狀空間; 豎井

A useful structural meaning.

Examples include:

* stairwell

* light well

* elevator/lift well

Practice 36

> “Smoke filled the stair ****well****.”

More naturally:

> “Smoke filled the ****stairwell****.”

「煙霧充滿了****樓梯井／樓梯間****。」

Practice 37

> “The lift moves inside a vertical ****well****.”

「升降機在垂直的****井道****內移動。」

****well** — structural = 建築或機械結構中向下／向上延伸的井狀空間

Usually appears in compounds rather than bare ****well****.

19. ****well** = liquid rise/gather (液體) — 湧出; 湧起; 積聚

Here, ****well**** is a verb.

Practice 38

> “Tears ****welled**** in her eyes.”

「淚水在她眼中**湧起／積聚**。」

Practice 39

> “Water **welled** from the ground.”

「水從地下**湧出**。」

****well — verb = 液體由內部逐漸湧出、升起或積聚****

This is a genuinely distinct verb meaning.

20. ****emotion wells (情緒) — 湧起; 湧上心頭****

A figurative extension of liquid rising.

Practice 40

> “Anger **welled** inside him.”

「憤怒在他心中**湧起**。」

Practice 41

> “A feeling of relief **welled** inside her.”

「一股如釋重負的感覺在她心中**湧現**。」

****well — emotion = 某種強烈情緒像液體一樣逐漸湧起****

This is slightly literary.

21. ****well-being = physical/emotional state of being healthy and comfortable — 身心健康; 福祉****

A highly useful family extension.

Practice 42

> “Sleep is important for your **well-being**.”

「睡眠對你的**身心健康**很重要。」

Practice 43

> “The company introduced policies to improve employee **well-being**.”

「公司推出政策改善員工的**身心福祉**。」

well-being = 身體、心理和生活狀態健康、安穩並有良好生活質素的狀態

This is a lexical family extension rather than another sense of bare **well**.

22. **wellness = active state/practice of maintaining health — 健康狀態; 健康生活概念**

Practice 44

> “The hotel has a large **wellness** centre.”

「酒店有一個大型**康體／健康中心**。」

Practice 45

> “Employee **wellness** programmes have become more common.”

「員工**健康促進計劃**變得愈來愈普遍。」

wellness = 維持或提升身體、心理和整體健康的狀態／活動理念

Useful distinction:

* **well-being** = one's overall state of welfare/health

* **wellness** = often the active pursuit or industry around maintaining health

23. **well-known = widely known/famous — 廣為人知的; 著名的**

Practice 46

> “It is a **well-known** brand.”

「這是一個**廣為人知的品牌**。」

Practice 47

> “She is **well known** for her research.”

「她因自己的研究而**廣為人知**。」

well-known = 被很多人認識／知道的

Note hyphen:

> a **well-known** brand

but:

> the brand is **well known**

24. **well-off** = financially comfortable — 經濟寬裕的; 富裕的

Practice 48

> “They are relatively **well-off**.”

「他們的經濟狀況相當**寬裕**。」

Practice 49

> “The area is popular with **well-off** families.”

「這個地區很受**較富裕家庭**歡迎。」

well-off = 擁有足夠金錢／資產, 生活相對富裕舒適的

This is a useful compound family extension.

25. **better / best** as comparative/superlative of well (做得好／健康) — 更好／最好

Because **well** is irregular.

Adverb:

> “She sings **well**.”
> “She sings **better** now.”
> “She sings **best** in the morning.”

「她唱得好／現在唱得更好／早上唱得最好。」

Health:

> “I feel **well**.”
> “I feel **better** today.”

「我感覺身體不錯／今天好一點了。」

better / best serve as the comparative/superlative forms of **well** in relevant senses.

But they also belong heavily to the **good** family, so I would not duplicate their entire polysemy here unless we later explicitly curate **good/better/best**.

Important distinction: **well** vs **good**

This is perhaps the most important distinction.

good

normally adjective:

> “She is a **good** singer.”

「她是一位好歌手。」

well

normally adverb:

> “She sings **well**.”

「她唱得很好。」

So:

> “The advertisement worked **well**.” 

not normally:

> “The advertisement worked **good**.” ❌

Exception: **well** = healthy

Because **well** can itself be an adjective:

> “I am well.”

= **我身體很好／我沒有生病。**

Compare:

> “I am good.”

usually means something different:

* 我很好 (general conversational reply in some varieties)

* 我是好人

* 我的能力不錯

So:

> **feel well** = 身體舒服／健康

> **feel good** = 感覺良好, 範圍更廣

Important distinction: **well** vs **fine**

well

can mean healthy or functioning successfully.

fine

can mean acceptable, satisfactory, or healthy enough.

> “The machine works well.”

「機器運作良好。」

> “The machine is fine.”

「機器沒有問題。」

Slightly different emphasis.

Important distinction: **well** vs **successfully**

well

evaluates **quality/effectiveness**.

successfully

specifically indicates the goal was achieved.

> “She performed well but did not win.”

「她表現很好，但沒有贏。」

So **well** does not necessarily mean ultimate success in competition.

In your advertising sentence, though:

> **worked well**

naturally means the advertisement was **effective**.

Important distinction: **well** vs **very**

Well can intensify certain words, but cannot freely replace **very**.

> **well aware** ✓

> **very aware** ✓

> **well prepared** ✓

> **very prepared** possible, but different style

But:

> *well beautiful* ❌

You need:

> **very beautiful**

So intensifier **well** has restricted collocations.

Important distinction: **well vs thoroughly**

Sometimes:

> “Wash it well.”

= 洗乾淨／徹底清洗

But **thoroughly** more explicitly means complete in every detail.

> “The system was thoroughly tested.”

「系統經過徹底測試。」

Well is broader and more conversational.

Important distinction: **as well vs too vs also**

All can mean 「也」.

also

usually mid-sentence:

> “I also bought a charger.”

too

usually near the end:

> “I bought a charger too.”

as well

usually near the end:

> “I bought a charger as well.”

As well and **too** are especially close.

Important distinction: **well-being vs wellness**

well-being

= overall physical, emotional, and life welfare

wellness

= health condition/practices aimed at maintaining well-being; also common in the health industry

> employee well-being = 員工整體福祉

> wellness programme = 健康促進計劃

Family-extension sweep

After the full sweep, the useful modern family includes:

* **well — successfully/effectively** = 有效地／好好地

* **well — skillfully** = 做得好／高水準地

* **well — satisfactorily** = 順利地

* **well — thoroughly** = 充分地／徹底地

* **well — degree** = 遠遠／大大

* **well worth** = 非常值得

* **well — healthy** = 健康的

* **well — satisfactory state** = 安好／沒有問題

* **Well, ...** = 嗯／那麼／這個嘛

* **Well?** = 怎樣？／然後呢？

* **as well** = 也

* **as well as** = 以及／除了……也……

* **may/might as well** = 不如／反正可以

* **well and truly** = 完完全全地
 * **well — noun: water** = 井
 * **well — noun: oil/gas** = 油井／氣井
 * **well — verb** = 湧出／湧起
 * **well-being** = 身心健康／福祉
 * **wellness** = 健康狀態／健康促進
 * **well-known** = 廣為人知的
 * **well-off** = 經濟寬裕的
 * **better/best** = well 的不規則比較級／最高級之一

I would not flood the family with every **well- + adjective** compound—there are hundreds. We should include only lexicalized or especially useful ones.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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well — effectively	某項行動、方法或系統成功達到預期目的, 效果令人滿意地
well — skillfully	某項技能或表現達到良好／高水準地
well — satisfactory progress	某件事情進展或結果順利、令人滿意地
well — thoroughly	某件事進行得充分、徹底或深入地
well + adjective/participle	表示某狀態達到很高、充分的程度
well — degree	與某個時間、數量或程度界線相差很遠地
well worth	價值／好處足夠高, 因此非常值得
well — healthy	身體健康、沒有生病或明顯不適的
well — satisfactory state	情況正常、令人安心、沒有問題的
Well, ...	用來整理思緒、緩和語氣、引出回答或轉換話題
Well?	催促對方回答、繼續說或告知結果
as well	另外也包括某人／某事; 也
as well as	除了某人／某事之外, 另一項亦包括在內
may/might as well	在現有情況下, 某行動是合理或沒有更好替代的做法
well and truly	強調某狀態完整、徹底而確實成立
well — noun: water	為取得地下水而挖／鑽的深洞
well — noun: oil/gas	為抽取地下石油或天然氣而鑽出的井
well — verb	液體由內部逐漸湧出、升起或積聚
well — emotion	強烈情緒像液體一樣逐漸湧起
well-being	身體、心理和生活整體健康安穩的狀態／福祉
wellness	維持和提升整體健康的狀態／健康實踐概念
well-known	被很多人認識、知道的; 廣為人知的
well-off	經濟條件良好、生活較富裕的

For your original sentence

> “Another reason it **worked so well** was that it sold more than a product...”

The exact meaning is:

well = 有效地、成功地達到廣告原本想產生的效果

So:

> **worked so well**

= **「效果這麼好／這麼有效」**

It does **not** mean:

*「健康」

*「井」

*「嗯」

And yes — **well** was another excellent catch from our second-pass scan. It looks tiny and ordinary, but it is one of English's most multifunctional everyday words.